Even newly baptized Catholics were chastised under the regime, accused of having switched religions only for political security while continuing to practice their true religion in secret. This was usually referred to as “crypto-Hinduism.”

Insisting that Catholicism was the one true faith, Catholic missionaries made sure to burn all books they found written in indigenous languages, including Sanskrit, Arabic, Konkani, and Marathi. In addition, imported books on Protestant Christianity—a movement gaining popularity in Europe—were strictly banned. All the most horrific legislation that was employed in Europe was mimicked in India. Those people found guilty of heresy were fined, publicly flogged, deported to Mozambique, imprisoned, burned in effigy, or burned at the stake. Though anyone stepping up as a witness at the heresy trials was given anonymity, there was very little an accused person could do to prove their innocence. Their confessions were extracted under torture, and if they recanted, it only served to incriminate them further as evidence of poor character.

When a person was convicted of heresy by the Goan Inquisition, their possessions were appropriated by the state and any religious paraphernalia was destroyed. In addition to personal possessions, Portugal stole public lands on which temples and religious structures were erected, then razed them all to the ground. In all, at least 760 Hindu temples were destroyed over the course of the Inquisition, and Hindus were forced to attend Catholic church services regularly to hear their own belief systems ridiculed. In 1620, it was made illegal for Hindus to perform their own marriage ceremonies.

As the accusation, punishments, and public book burnings continued, Hindus gathered what remained of their sacred objects and fled the state. Goa would remain under Portuguese rule for more than four centuries after the establishment of the Goan Inquistion.